

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Victims of Progress



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write a narrative about the past.
- I can say what had been happening or what had happened.
- I can report past actions or events.

Ask your partner:

- Have you read stories about past events in your country's history? Which ones?
- Do you think stories from the past are always based on fact? Why or why not? Explain.





Let's Explore!

A Sauk **tribe*** has unexpected visitors.

* A "tribe" is a group of people that includes families and relatives who have the same language, customs, and beliefs.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Gold and crimson blanketed the hills and valleys of Michigan Lake highlands. It was a glorious fall season. Summer crops had been plentiful and there was sense of optimism and peace in the air. The Sauk tribe had been preparing for a long winter for months. Women and children had dug potatoes for a week in the crisp air. The men had dried the meat and were now smoking fish. There were experts in handling cold, harsh conditions. It would have been remarkable to have seen the level of planning required to handle a North American winter in the 1800s. Their resourcefulness had been allowing them to thrive in this environment for centuries.

Two agitated men on horseback suddenly appeared on the track leading to the longhouse. They were met by an elderly man who extended his hand in trust and friendship. One was the sheriff and the other was the man who had bought the title of the land beneath them. The sheriff claimed that they have arrested those who had disagreed with documents such as these in the past. Their faces showed fear and disdain for their company.

One of the trespassers then produced a paper, signed by the Governor. "According to the laws of this state, I am now the owner of these lands and everything they contain," he proclaimed. With that, they proceeded by removing all the contents of the huts including bedding, chairs and stoves. Eyes downcast, the old man stood in silence, watching his world crumble to his feet. The unwanted intruders then began to sprinkle oil throughout the settlement and set a match to it.

Within half an hour, thick smoke could be seen for miles. Tribe members came running from all directions, desperate to extinguish the blaze. It was a hopeless position. By nightfall, the glowing embers dotted the horizon and the wails of a culture could be heard in the darkness. This callous act is said to have marked the end of Sauk settlement in the area.





Let's Practice!

The authors write about a Sauk tribe's way of life.

Instructions: Match each sentence with its corresponding response. Write the number in front of each response.

- | | |
|--------------------------------|--|
| 1. Gold and crimson blanketed | a. ___ preparing for a long winter for months. |
| 2. Women and children had dug | b. ___ the hills and valleys of the Michigan Lake highlands. |
| 3. Their faces showed fear and | c. ___ been allowing them to thrive in this environment for centuries. |
| 4. The Sauk tribe had been | d. ___ the meat and were now smoking fish. |
| 5. Their resourcefulness had | e. ___ potatoes for weeks in the crisp air. |
| 6. The men had dried | f. ___ disdain for their company. |



Let's Practice!

The author reports on past events.

Instructions: Circle the correct option to complete the sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. It would have been remarkable (*to has see/ to have seen*) the level of planning required to handle a North American winter in the 1800s.
2. The sheriff claimed (*to have arrested/ to have arrest*) those who had disagreed with documents such as these in the past.
3. This callous act is said *to* (*have marked/ has marking*) the end of Sauk settlement in the area.
4. The elderly man is said to *have* (*welcomed/ welcomes*) the duo into the community.
5. The sheriff was known to *have* (*use/ used*) his position to destroy lives in the past.





Extension Activity

How much do you know about local history?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or to your local library and research past events in your area.
- Choose one event that interests you.
- Write notes about what happened.
- Now, write a narrative based on these past events.
- Include characters, setting and series of events.
- Use various forms of the Past tense.
- Include direct speech.
- When complete, read the narrative aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I research past events in my area.

☐ ☐

I write a narrative about the past based on a true event.

☐ ☐

I read my narrative aloud to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- crimson** (adjective): a deep purplish-red color
e.g. Gold and crimson blanketed the hills and valleys of the Michigan Lake highlands.
- longhouse** (noun): a long building constructed by Native American Tribes for community meetings
e.g. Two agitated men on horseback suddenly appeared on the track leading to the longhouse.
- to extend** (verb): to straighten out or to stretch out
e.g. They were met by an elderly man who extended his hand in trust and friendship.
- disdain** (noun): feeling of strong dislike or disapproval of someone or something you think does not deserve respect
e.g. Their faces showed fear and disdain for their company.
- to crumble at one's feet** (expression): to see something destroyed
e.g. Eyes downcast, the old man stood in silence, watching his world crumble at his feet.
- to extinguish** (verb): to cause something to stop burning
e.g. Tribe members came running from all directions, desperate to extinguish the blaze.
- ember** (noun): a glowing piece of coal or wood from a fire
e.g. By nightfall, the glowing embers of Indian communities dotted the horizon and the wails of a culture could be heard in the darkness.
- callous** (adjective): not feeling or showing any concern about the problems or suffering of other people
e.g. This callous act is said to have marked the end of Sauk settlement in the area.





Learning Points

The Narrative Tenses: Past Perfect and Past Perfect Continuous

Narrative tenses are the tenses used to discuss events in the past and to tell stories.

The Simple Past is the most common narrative tense. The Past Perfect and the Past Perfect Continuous can also help you explain what you want more efficiently.

Tense	Use	Example
Simple Past	Completed Actions/ Routines in the past	<i>Their faces showed fear and disdain for their company.</i>
Past Perfect	An action that happened before another past action	<i>The men had dried the meat and were now smoking fish.</i>
Past Perfect Continuous	An action that was in progress before another past action	<i>Their resourcefulness had been allowing them to thrive in this environment for centuries.</i>

Examples:

- *Gold and crimson blanketed the hills and valleys of the Michigan Lake highlands.*
- *The Sauk tribe had been preparing for a long winter for months.*
- *Their resourcefulness had been allowing them to thrive in this environment for centuries.*
- *Women and children had dug potatoes for weeks in the crisp air.*

